

The Site Inspection App

Setting it up, and using it on a job. About 30 minutes with questions.

The paper site inspection form is now an app. Same sections, same questions — on the iPad, with the photos attached where they belong, and the record passing between the office, the field and the technical team without anybody emailing a file.

Two things this session has to land.

Passing a job on without losing it, and getting your photos off the device. Everything else can be looked up.

App v1.4 · Form 4.2 · Companion to [01_Setup and User Guide](#) and [03_Handover and Version Control Protocol](#)

PRESENTER

Arrow keys or Space to move.

N

shows these notes on screen. Print to PDF, A4 landscape, background graphics ON — without it the coloured panels print as empty boxes. Do not explain waterproofing to waterproofers. Explain the tool, nothing else.

Why this exists

One good inspection is the whole quote.

Everything Dryspace quotes comes from the inspection. The proposal reads it, the quote reads the proposal, the contract reads the quote. A gap at inspection becomes a gap in the quote — and usually a phone call to you, days later, asking what you saw.

Basements have no signal

Anything needing a live connection fails at the moment it is needed.

It feeds the systems downstream

What you capture becomes the proposal, the quote, the contract.

Five people touch one job

Office, field, technical, sales, admin — it has to pass between them intact.

The app is a capture tool, not a decision-maker.

It records what you judge. It does not diagnose, and it does not replace the site visit.

PRESENTER

Keep this slide short — a minute at most. The audience already knows why inspections matter; what is new is that the record now travels on its own.

Installing it — about two minutes

- 1 **Open the link in Safari.** It has to be Safari, not Chrome: `https://ds-js1.github.io/dryspace-inspect/`
- 2 **Tap Share, then Add to Home Screen, then Add.** Share is the square with the arrow coming out of it.
- 3 **Open it once from the new icon, while you still have signal.** That first open is what stores the app on the device.

From then on, use the icon — never a browser tab.

The installed version gets protected storage. A browser tab can be cleared out from under you.

PRESENTER

Do this live on one person's iPad rather than describing it. Two minutes, and it removes the excuse. If somebody is on a Windows PC in the office, the same link installs from Edge or Chrome via the install icon in the address bar.

It works with no signal at all

This is the reassurance that matters most. Say it plainly and show it.

- **Everything is stored on the device.**

There is no server quietly keeping everyone in step, and nothing to wait for.

- **It saves within half a second** — every keystroke, tick and photo.

A *Saved [time]* indicator sits along the top of the form and confirms it.

- **Losing signal, locking the screen or a flat battery loses nothing.**

Capture is never blocked.

No warning the app can show will stop you taking a photo or answering a question. Running out of space is recoverable; a missed defect is not.

PRESENTER

Demonstration worth doing: put the iPad in aeroplane mode, type into a field, and point at *Saved* changing. Thirty seconds, and it answers the question people are actually holding.

The home screen

Seven controls, in this order. The sign-in and sync bar sits below them.

CONTROL	WHEN YOU USE IT
+ New inspection	A job that is not in SharePoint yet — including a walk-in
Take over an inspection from SharePoint	Picking up a job somebody has handed to you
Browse all inspections	Seeing every job in the library and who holds it
Import from a file (offline fallback)	Only when there is no signal
Recover work in progress	A lost or broken device — brings back the automatic backup
Download data backup (all inspections)	Your own safety copy of everything on the device
Check for app update	Rarely — the app tells you itself when there is one

PRESENTER

Do not walk through all seven. Point at the first three and say the rest are there when they are needed. The two that matter on day one are *New inspection* and *Take over an inspection from SharePoint*.

The office start

Section 01 is filled at a desk, before anyone drives anywhere.

- 1 **Tap + New inspection, set the stage to 01 Office** Fill Section 01 — client, property, both contacts, lead source.
- 2 **Paste the listing URL, and upload any floor plans in Section 11** This is the stage to do it. There is signal at a desk; there will not be in the basement.
- 3 **Change the stage to 02 Field, then hand it over** Set the stage *before* you hand over — the stage is part of the filename.

Six stages, one owner at a time.

OFFICE → FIELD → TECH → SALES → ADMIN → CLOSED

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The point to make here is that the field inspector should arrive on site with Section 01 already done. That is the whole reason the office stage exists.

On site

Sections 02 to 06, plus 03A. The site visit itself.

- **Blank fields are normal.**

The form is deliberately broader than any single job. Most inspections leave a lot blank, and that is correct. The completion counts exist to find genuine gaps, not to be driven to 100%.

- **Do not skip Section 03A.**

Asbestos likelihood, hazards, access and carry route, and the discharge point. All four affect safety and price.

- **To pause, just leave.**

Resume from the list any time. Nothing is lost by closing the app.

Your work is backed up while you go.

Every four minutes while the form is open, the app writes a copy to the inspection's `wip/` folder. It needs signal and a signed-in account, and it is silent when it cannot run. A lost or broken device no longer means a lost day.

`wip/` is never the baton.

It is a working copy for recovering a device. The live record is always the file in `current/`.

PRESENTER

Stress the `wip/` distinction. If somebody comes away thinking `wip/` is where the record lives, they will go looking for the wrong file.

The action row — at the *top* of the form

Directly beneath the stage selector. This moved in v1.4.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Hand over through SharePoint	Puts the record in <code>current/</code> and files the previous version in <code>archive/</code>
Send report (email / SharePoint)	Builds the report and opens the share sheet
Share photo & video files	Shares the untouched originals through the share sheet
Share draft (offline fallback)	The old file-based handover, for when there is no signal
Print / PDF	Prints the form as it stands

If you are training somebody from an older card, this is the difference.

These buttons used to sit below every section, which on a phone meant scrolling past eleven sections to hand over. Anything showing them at the foot of the form is out of date.

PRESENTER

This is the single most likely thing to be done the old way out of habit. Show the row on a real screen rather than reading the table out.

Photos

Take them in the Camera app. Attach them. Upload when you are back in signal.

Take photos in the Camera app, not in the form.

Two reasons: your camera roll keeps an independent second copy, and the location detail survives. Neither is true if you shoot inside the app.

- 1 On site, with no signal** Photograph what you need, then attach each one to the right field. Nothing uploads yet, so nothing is waiting on a connection.
- 2 Back in signal — car, office, wifi** Sign in once with your Dryspace Microsoft account, then tap **Upload now** on the home screen. On the form itself, an **Upload 3 photos** button appears at the top whenever something is waiting.
- 3 Wait until it says *All photos uploaded*** While it runs the button reads *Uploading · 2 left · 45%*. Until it finishes, those photos exist only on your device.

You cannot lose a photo by uploading it.

The app reads every file back out of SharePoint and checks it arrived complete before counting it as done. Nothing is removed from your device on the strength of an upload that has not been confirmed.

PRESENTER

Demonstrate rather than describe: take a photo, attach it, show the count waiting, upload it, and open SharePoint to show it arrive. That one demonstration answers more questions than any amount of explaining. “Will I lose my photos” is the first question people ask. Answer it before they ask.

What the card tells you about its files

Every inspection on the home screen says where its files are. Read it before you delete anything.

IT SAYS	IT MEANS
3 files · all uploaded	Safe. Every file is in SharePoint and has been read back and confirmed
· 1 waiting to upload	Still on the device only. Needs signal and a sign-in
· 1 uploading	In flight right now. Leave it running
· 1 needs attention	Tap Try again. If it repeats, tell the office <i>before</i> deleting anything
no files on this device	Exactly that — and not “all uploaded”

Never delete an inspection that still has photos waiting.

The card tells you. If in doubt, do not delete — nobody has ever been in trouble for keeping a job too long.

PRESENTER

The last row is the one to dwell on. `no files on this device` looks reassuring and is not; it is what you see after the originals have gone, or on a record you took over.

The measurement schedule

Section 07. This is what pricing works from.

Wall face, length, height, treatment — one row per face. It is the technical stage's job, but the field inspector's photographs and notes are what make it possible to complete without a second visit.

Metres and millimetres.

Australian units throughout, and dates in Australian format with the day name.

PRESENTER

If the room is all field inspectors, this slide is thirty seconds — just say who does it and why their photos matter to it. If technical staff are present, stop and work an example.

Handing over — four steps

One baton, never a copy.

At any moment exactly one file is the live record, and it lives in SharePoint. The copy on your device is a working scratch pad.

- 1 **Set your stage and your name** Top of the inspection. This is what stamps the filename and the audit trail.
- 2 **Tap *Hand over through SharePoint*** Top of the form. It uploads the record into `current/` and moves the previous version into `archive/` for you.
- 3 **Tell the next person** Send a link to the folder — never the file.
- 4 **Then delete your device copy** Once they confirm they have it. The app will not do this for you, and it should not — deleting somebody's only copy of a day's work on their behalf is not software's decision.

The last step is the one people skip.

Keeping your copy “just in case” is how one job ends up being edited in two places, with nobody sure which version the client was quoted from. Your work is backed up to `wip/` automatically, so there is nothing to keep it for.

PRESENTER

This changed in v1.4 and it is the change most likely to be done the old way. It used to be five steps: the export, the upload to `current/` and the move to `archive/` were all done by hand — and on a phone they could not be done at all, because the share sheet there offers WhatsApp, not SharePoint. Anyone trained on v1.3 needs the handover card again. Full protocol is 03 §4; if it has already gone wrong, 03 §8.

Taking an inspection over

The other half of the handover, and new in v1.4.

Take over an inspection from SharePoint lists everything with a file waiting in `current/`, one row per job, with a filter box across the top. Tap one and it comes onto your device. Nobody has to send you anything.

The photos arrive as thumbnails, not as files.

They are already in the inspection's `photos/` folder, so sending them a second time would be pointless. Each shows its thumbnail with *in SharePoint · tap to fetch* underneath. Tap it while you have signal and the full original comes down.

Fetch what you need before you lose signal.

With no signal, a thumbnail is all you have. This is worth thirty seconds in the car.

Browse all inspections shows every job in the library — not only the ones waiting — with its baton state on the row: **WAITING**, **IN PROGRESS**, or **NOT HANDED OVER**. From there you can take it over, read it without taking it, open the folder, or ask the holder for the baton.

PRESENTER

The thumbnail point catches people out. Somebody takes a job over in the office, drives to site, and finds they cannot open the photos. Say it twice.

Where everything lives

One folder per inspection, holding all of it.

Site Inspections ▶ INS-2026-0142 - Smith - 12 Marine Pde, Kirra/
 current/ one file, ever – the live record
 archive/ every past handover
 wip/ automatic backups while you work – NEVER the baton
 photos/ the app puts these here by itself

Files name themselves, and carry the client name, so a file that has been downloaded or emailed still says whose job it is:

DS_Draft_INS-2026-0142_Smith_S02-FIELD_2026-08-15T1430_JS.json

Two files in `current/` means something has gone wrong.

Do not guess which is right. Check the timestamps and the initials in the filename, and ask before overwriting anything. The procedure is in 03 §8.

PRESENTER

Have the SharePoint library open on the projector for this slide. The tree makes far more sense next to the real thing.

What the app asks before it files

Five details decide how a record *files*, rather than what it *says*.

FIELD	WHAT IT DECIDES
Inspection number	The folder sorts by it, and every photo filename carries it
Client name	Names the folder, and pins into every photo filename
Property address	Names the folder
Inspection date	Indexed as a library column
Your name	Records who handed the record on

The app names any that are blank — once before the first upload, and again at each handover — shows the folder the record would file as, and lets you go back and fill them in.

It never blocks anything.

Not the photo, not the upload, not the handover. Tap OK and it goes. A blank field mid-inspection is legitimate.

The folder name is fixed by the first upload.

After that, filling the blanks in corrects the record and the library columns but renames nothing. A record with no number, client or address files as `Unfiled` .

PRESENTER

The useful habit to teach: put the inspection number and client in before the first photo goes up, not after. Ten seconds then, unfixable later.

When something looks wrong

IT SAYS	DO THIS
"No connection"	Normal in a basement. Try again when you have signal. Nothing is lost
"Please sign in again"	Tap Sign in. Losing signal does not sign you out; this only appears if the sign-in has genuinely expired
"Need attention"	Tap Try again. If it keeps failing, tell the office <i>before</i> deleting anything
"A new version is ready"	Tap Update. It only appears on the home screen, never mid-inspection
Somebody else has handed this over	Two people have worked the same job. It names who and when. Talk to them before continuing — continuing archives their version rather than deleting it

PRESENTER

None of these are emergencies and none of them lose data. Say that out loud — an inspector who thinks a red message means lost work will stop using the app.

What to take away

- 1 **Use the installed icon, never a browser tab.**
- 2 **Photos in the Camera app, then attach.** Upload when you are back in signal, and wait for *All photos uploaded*.
- 3 **Handover is four steps, and the last one is deleting your copy.** Only once the next person confirms they have it.
- 4 **Blank fields are normal.** A wide form filled in accurately beats a narrow form that forces guesses.

Keep the two quick cards where you work.

One in the vehicle, one at the desk. There is also a twelve-minute self-paced module you can run any time, on the iPad, with nothing to log into:
`Training/Training_Module.html`

Full detail: `01_Setup and User Guide` . Handover protocol, including what to do when it has already gone wrong: `03_Handover and Version Control Protocol` .

PRESENTER

Finish by offering to sit down with anyone for ten minutes on a live job. That offer is worth more than both cards, and the people who need it most will not ask in front of the room.